

R2F T R A D I N G

THE ICT FUNDED-TRADER PLAYBOOK

The setups, the checklist, the risk rules, and the
mindset that keep a funded account alive.

By Harvest Wright . 10+ years trading ICT

r2ftrading.com

Why You Keep Failing Phase 2

Most traders who fail funded challenges do not fail because they lack ICT knowledge. They can name every concept: order blocks, fair value gaps, liquidity, killzones. They fail because knowing a concept and executing it under pressure with real money on the line are two different skills.

This playbook is the execution layer. It covers the handful of setups worth trading, the checklist that keeps you out of the bad ones, the risk rules that actually pass a challenge, and the mindset that stops you giving the account back in week two. Read it once, then keep the checklist where you can see it before every trade.

The 3 Setups That Actually Work

You do not need twenty setups. You need three you can spot in seconds and trade the same way every time. Here they are.

1. The Order Block Reversal

The last opposing candle before a strong move that breaks structure. It marks where institutions filled their orders. Find it by marking the origin of a displacement move that shifted market structure. Wait for price to return to that block, look for a lower-timeframe shift in your favor, and enter on the reaction. The idea is invalid if price closes cleanly through the block.

2. The Fair Value Gap Fill

A three-candle imbalance where price moved so fast it left a gap that never traded. Mark the gap left by a displacement candle. When price returns to rebalance it, enter at the edge of the gap with a confirming shift on the lower timeframe. If price fills the gap and keeps going against you, the idea is done.

3. The Liquidity Sweep and OTE

Price runs an obvious high or low to grab resting stops, then reverses. Mark equal highs and lows and recent swing points, because that is where the liquidity sits. After the sweep and a shift in structure, enter on the 62 to 79 percent retracement, the optimal trade entry. No reversal after the sweep means no trade.

The pattern behind all three is one idea: price seeks liquidity, then delivers back to an inefficiency or an unfilled order. Once you see that, every setup makes sense.

The Pre-Trade Checklist

Run this before every entry. If you cannot check all six, you do not have a trade. This one habit removes most of the trades that blow accounts.

BEFORE YOU CLICK, CONFIRM:

- ✓ My higher-timeframe bias is clear, and this trade agrees with it.
- ✓ Price swept liquidity or tapped a valid order block or fair value gap.
- ✓ There is a lower-timeframe shift in structure confirming the turn.
- ✓ Entry, stop, and target are set before I click, and reward is at least 2x the risk.
- ✓ My stop sits where the idea is proven wrong, not at a random round number.
- ✓ I am inside a session that matters (London or New York killzone), not chasing a dead market.

Risk Rules That Pass Funded Challenges

You pass a challenge by not losing, not by winning big. These rules are built for the prop-firm rulebook.

- Risk a fixed, small percentage per trade, 0.5 to 1 percent of the account. Never size up to make back a loss.
- Know the firm's max daily loss and stop yourself at half of it. If they allow 5 percent, you stop at 2.5. That buffer is what keeps you funded.
- Aim for steady, not spectacular. Two or three clean trades a day beats twenty, and most firms' consistency rules reward it anyway.
- Bank partials. Take some off at 2R, move your stop to breakeven, let the rest run. A trade that can only break even or win changes how you think.
- One setup, traded the same way, every time. The edge is in the repetition, not the variety.

Trade the challenge exactly like it is your own live money. The habits you build in the challenge are the habits you keep on the funded account.

The Mindset That Keeps the Account Alive

The account is rarely blown by a bad setup. It is blown by a good trader breaking their own rules after a loss, a win, or an hour of boredom.

- You get paid to follow your process, not to be right. Score your day on whether you followed your rules, not on the profit and loss.
- The trade after a loss is the dangerous one. Revenge sizing is the fastest way to fail. If you feel it rising, close the platform for the day.
- Boredom is a position. Sitting on your hands through a dead session is a skill, and it is where discipline is really tested.
- Journal every trade with a screenshot and one line: did I follow my plan, yes or no. Review it weekly. That single question improves you faster than any new concept.

Where To Go From Here

This playbook is the map. The hard part is installing these habits on your own charts, under pressure, when it actually counts. That is what the coaching does: one on one, on your setups, fixing your specific leaks.

If you want a hand, start with the free class, then book a free call. No pressure, just an honest look at where you are and what to fix first.

Free class: r2ftrading.com/free-class
Book a free call: r2ftrading.com/contact